

The English test can vary considerably depending on where you live, therefore it is important to check the prospective school's website or speak to them beforehand to find out what type of English test they do. An English test could include any number of the following:

- a writing task
- a reading comprehension test
- a multiple-choice English grammar and punctuation test

The writing test usually lasts anywhere from 20 to 50 minutes, with the reading test varying from 30 minutes to an hour.

The English test is used to assess your child's knowledge of grammar, punctuation, spelling, comprehension and, sometimes, their writing ability too. It aims to test children on the skills they have learnt during primary school.

In addition to a sound knowledge of grammar, punctuation and spelling, they'll need a wide and varied vocabulary, which can also help with the verbal reasoning tests. Their comprehension skills should be strong – especially their ability to make inferences based on clues and information given in the text. However, it is also important that they have experience of reading questions carefully and accurately, working to a time limit and remaining calm.

To help support your child for the English test, encourage them to read, read and read some more! A great variety of fiction and non-fiction across a range of genres will help your child to develop their vocabulary and knowledge. Most children read independently once they reach this age, but it would be a good idea to have a look at the book they are reading, select some words that you may think are tricky for your child and test them on the meaning of the words. If they are not sure, discuss the meaning of each word with your child and practise using it in context. You might also read a book together and discuss their understanding of the character's actions and motives, the plot and what they think the author is trying to achieve. Discussing reading is a great way of developing depth of thinking.

You can also encourage your child to write in a range of styles. Try to contextualise this and link it to something that they enjoy. For example, if you've been on a day trip to the zoo, you could encourage them to write a recount of the visit, an information text about their favourite animal, a persuasive booklet advertising the zoo or even simply a fictional story set there.

For a thorough guide to all aspects of the 11+ test, try our [Survival Guide for Parents/Carers.](#)



English Grammar and Punctuation



There is a wide range of questions that your child might encounter on the English grammar and punctuation test.

Your child might be asked to:

- identify word and sentence types
- identify adverbial phrases
- select the correct article or determiner
- identify correct uses of punctuation
- select appropriate punctuation to complete a sentence
- select appropriate words or phrases to complete a sentence
- identify contractions
- identify tenses



Usually, the questions on this test are in a multiple-choice format.

For example:



Which of the following phrases is written in the present progressive tense?

Tick one.

- ☐ was running
- ☐ is running
- ☐ has run
- ☐ will run



For example:



Tick the boxes to show where commas should be placed.



Drake bought bread milk eggs and sandwiches at the shop.



11+ English Practice Paper

Grammar and Punctuation: Test 1

1. In the sentence below, which words are adjectives? Tick one answer.

The beautiful, red roses were in bloom during the warm weather.

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ beautiful, red, bloom | ☐ beautiful, were, warm |
| ☐ red, during warm, weather | ☐ beautiful, red, warm |

2. Name the sentence type below. Tick one answer.

What's your favourite food?

- | | |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| ☐ statement | ☐ command |
| ☐ question | ☐ exclamation |

3. Place a tick by the complex sentence below.

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ John yawned. He was feeling very tired. | ☐ John yawned because he was feeling tired. |
| ☐ John yawned and stretched his arms. | ☐ John was feeling tired. |

4. Which word or words in the sentence below make an adverbial phrase? Tick one.

The old man with a hat on his head walked through the park.

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ the old man | ☐ walked |
| ☐ a hat on his head | ☐ through the park |



5. Which word is a preposition in the sentence below? Tick one.

The small, old building sat between the forest of skyscrapers that filled the city.

- | | |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| ☐ sat | ☐ filled |
| ☐ between | ☐ the |

6. Select the articles which would best fit the paragraph below (in order). Tick one.

___ rain was very heavy. Mr Wei needed ___ umbrella but all he had was ___ hat.

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| ☐ a, the, an | ☐ the, an, a |
| ☐ an, the, a | ☐ the, a, an |

7. Which is the modal verb in the sentence below? Tick one.

Jemima and Outi wondered if they should eat the chocolate cake.

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| ☐ wondered | ☐ they |
| ☐ if | ☐ should |

8. Which is the auxiliary verb in the sentence below? Tick one.

I have finished my homework so can I go out to play?

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| ☐ have | ☐ go |
| ☐ finished | ☐ play |



11+ English Practice Paper

Grammar and Punctuation: Test 1

Answers

1. In the sentence below, which words are adjectives? Tick one answer.

The **beautiful**, **red** roses were in bloom during the warm weather.

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ beautiful, red, bloom | ☐ beautiful, were, warm |
| ☐ red, during warm, weather | ☒ beautiful, red, warm |

Beautiful, **red** and **warm** are all adjectives.

2. Name the sentence type below. Tick one answer.

What's your favourite food?

- | | |
|--|--------------------------------------|
| ☐ statement | ☐ command |
| ☒ question | ☐ exclamation |

We know that the sentence is a **question** because it ends in a question mark.

3. Place a tick by the complex sentence below.

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ John yawned. He was feeling very tired. | ☒ John yawned because he was feeling tired. |
| ☐ John yawned and stretched his arms. | ☐ John was feeling tired. |

This is a complex sentence because it includes a main clause (**John yawned**) and a subordinate clause (**he was feeling tired**) separated by a subordinating conjunction (**because**).

4. Which words in the sentence below make an adverbial phrase? Tick one.

After walking through the park, the old man had a rest.

☐ the old man

☐ walked

☐ a hat on his head

☒ through the park

The phrase **through the park** is an adverbial phrase, because it modifies the verb 'walked'.

5. Which word is a preposition in the sentence below? Tick one.

The small, old building sat between the forest of skyscrapers that filled the city.

☐ sat

☐ filled

☒ between

☐ the

The word **between** is a preposition because it tells us **where** something is.

6. Select the articles which would best fit the paragraph below (in order). Tick one.

___ rain was very heavy. Mr Wei needed ___ umbrella but all he had was ___ hat.

☐ a, the, an

☒ the, an, a

☐ an, the, a

☐ the, a, an

We need to look at the words **after** the missing articles to work out which articles fit in. **The** rain, **an** umbrella, **a** hat.

7. Which is the modal verb in the sentence below? Tick one.

Jemima and Outi wondered if they should eat the chocolate cake.

☐ wondered

☐ they

☐ if

☒ should

The modal verb is **should**. Modal verbs show possibility, ability or necessity.

8. Which is the auxiliary verb in the sentence below? Tick one.

I have finished my homework so can I go out to play?

☒ have

☐ go

☐ finished

☐ play

The auxiliary verb is **have**. Auxiliary verbs are used to form tenses or turn statements into questions.

11+ English Practice Paper

Grammar and Punctuation: Test 2

1. Which sentence correctly uses commas to show that Mike, Pedro and Sian all went to the park together.

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ After meeting Mike, Pedro and Sian went to the park. | ☐ After meeting Mike and Pedro, Sian went to the park. |
| ☐ After meeting, Mike, Pedro and Sian went to the park. | ☐ After meeting Mike, Pedro, Sian went to the park. |

2. Which is the relative pronoun in the sentence below? Tick one.

I go swimming at 7 a.m. which means I don't have breakfast until 8.30 a.m.

- | | |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------|
| ☐ I | ☐ which |
| ☐ at | ☐ have |

3. Which sentence is correctly punctuated? Tick one.

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ "I'll take two please", she said to the shopkeeper. | ☐ "i'll take two please," she said to the shopkeeper. |
| ☐ "I'll take two please," she said to the shopkeeper. | ☐ I'll take two please, "she said to the shopkeeper." |

4. Choose a suitable adverb to finish this sentence. Tick one.

Donald ate his food _____.

- | | |
|--------------------------------------|--|
| ☐ beautifully | ☐ inquisitively |
| ☐ tomorrow | ☐ quickly |



5. Which of the sentences below is a compound sentence? Tick one.

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Below the crashing waves, a shoal of silvery fish swam. | ☐ The shoal of silvery fish swam nervously away from the approaching dolphins. |
| ☐ The seagulls flew close to the shimmering surface but they couldn't catch the darting fish. | ☐ Late one evening, by a sunken ship, a shoal of silvery fish swam. |

6. Which pair of words can be contracted in the following sentence? Tick one.

Frankie was worried because she would not be able to finish in time.

- | | |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| ☐ Frankie was | ☐ not be |
| ☐ would not | ☐ in time |

7. Which sentence below uses the past progressive? Tick one.

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ The lion walked. | ☐ The lion is walking. |
| ☐ The lion was walking. | ☐ The lion had walked. |

8. Which word is a verb in the following sentence? Tick one.

The colourful birds flew through the canopy of the rainforest.

- | | |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| ☐ colourful | ☐ through |
| ☐ flew | ☐ of |



11+ English Practice Paper

Grammar and Punctuation: Test 2

Answers

1. Which sentence correctly uses commas to show that **Mike, Pedro and Sian** all went to the park together.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ After meeting Mike, Pedro and Sian went to the park. | ☐ After meeting Mike and Pedro, Sian went to the park. |
| ☒ After meeting, Mike, Pedro and Sian went to the park. | ☐ After meeting Mike, Pedro, Sian went to the park. |

The adverbial **after meeting**, shows that they all met at the same time.

2. Which is the relative pronoun in the sentence below? Tick one.

I go swimming at 7 a.m. which means I don't have breakfast until 8.30 a.m.

- | | |
|-----------------------------|---|
| ☐ I | ☒ which |
| ☐ at | ☐ have |

Which is the relative pronoun. Relative pronouns include that, which, whose, whom, where, when and who.

3. Which sentence is correctly punctuated? Tick one.

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ "I'll take two please", she said to the shopkeeper. | ☐ "i'll take two please," she said to the shopkeeper. |
| ☒ "I'll take two please," she said to the shopkeeper. | ☐ I'll take two please, "she said to the shopkeeper." |

The **comma** needs to go before the closing inverted commas.

4. Choose a suitable adverb to finish this sentence. Tick one.

Donald ate his food _____.

☐ beautifully

☐ inquisitively

☐ tomorrow

☒ quickly

The adverb **quickly** is the most appropriate in this case, as it describes how he ate the food. **Beautifully** would not usually be used to describe how someone eats, **tomorrow** does not fit with the tense and **inquisitively** would only be appropriate if he was very curious about the food.

5. Which of the sentences below is a compound sentence? Tick one.

☐ Below the crashing waves, a shoal of silvery fish swam.

☒ The shoal of silvery fish swam nervously away from the approaching dolphins.

☐ The seagulls flew close to the shimmering surface but they couldn't catch the darting fish.

☐ Late one evening, by a sunken ship, a shoal of silvery fish swam.

Option 3 is a **compound sentence** because it includes two main clauses separated by a co-ordinating conjunction.

6. Which pair of words can be contracted in the following sentence? Tick one.

Frankie was worried because she would not be able to finish in time.

☐ Frankie was

☐ not be

☒ would not

☐ in time

The words **would** and **not** can be contracted to form **wouldn't**.

7. Which sentence below uses the past progressive? Tick one.

☐ The lion walked.

☐ The lion is walking.

☒ The lion was walking.

☐ The lion had walked.

The **past progressive** is used to describe an action that was ongoing in the past but has ended now.

8. Which word is a verb in the following sentence? Tick one.

The colourful birds flew through the canopy of the rainforest.

☐ colourful

☐ through

☒ flew

☐ of

The verb is flew because it expresses an action.

11+ English Practice Paper

Grammar and Punctuation: Test 3

1. Which word should be used to complete the sentence below? Tick one
Ola and Kamil received the keys to _____ new home.

☐ there

☐ they're

☐ their

☐ theyre

2. Tick the statements which are true about the sentence below.

Later that day, Ben picked up his pen and finished writing his story for school.

☐ The sentence contains four nouns

☐ The sentence contains one proper noun

☐ The sentence contains a collective noun

☐ The sentence contains at least one concrete noun

3. Which word is the pronoun in the following sentence? Tick one.

Some people don't like mince pies because they contain dried fruit.

☐ some

☐ because

☐ people

☐ they

4. Underline the determiners in the following sentence.

The teacher didn't know whose coat it was.



5. Which words make an expanded noun phrase in the following sentence? Tick one.

The ferocious dragon sat in his cave waiting for the knight to approach.

☐ The ferocious dragon

☐ waiting for the knight

☐ in his cave

☐ to approach

6. Which conjunction could be added to the sentence below so that it makes sense?
Tick one.

_____ it was getting late, Jake couldn't put down his book and go to sleep.

☐ because

☐ when

☐ although

☐ whether

7. Underline the subordinate clause in each of the sentences below.

Jivan and his sister entered the tunnel even though they knew it could be dangerous.

Place the cakes in the oven until they turn golden-brown.

When he was hungry, Ewan ate a banana.

While the teacher was talking, Imran played with his fidget spinner.

8. Which of the following is a simple sentence? Tick one.

☐ The sleek, black jaguar had a refreshing drink of cool water.

☐ The jaguar drank water while the birds twittered above.

☐ After hunting, the jaguar had a drink of water.

☐ The jaguar walked to the river and had a drink of water.



11+ English Practice Paper

Grammar and Punctuation: Test 3

Answers

1. Which word should be used to complete the sentence below? Tick one.

Ola and Kamil received the keys to _____ new home.

☐ there

☐ they're

☒ their

☐ theyre

The correct word is **their** because it shows possession.

2. Tick the statements which are true about the sentence below.

Later that day, Ben picked up his pen and finished writing his story for school.

☐ The sentence contains four nouns

☒ The sentence contains one proper noun

☐ The sentence contains a collective noun

☒ The sentence contains at least one concrete noun

The statement contains one proper noun (**Ben**) and three concrete nouns (**Ben, pen** and **school**).

3. Which word is the pronoun in the following sentence? Tick one.

Some people don't like mince pies because they contain dried fruit.

☐ some

☐ because

☐ people

☒ they

The pronoun in the sentence is **they** which is being used to refer to **the mince pies**.

4. Underline the determiners in the following sentence.

The teacher didn't know whose coat it was.

The determiners in the sentence are **the** and **whose**.

5. Which words make an expanded noun phrase in the following sentence? Tick one.

The ferocious dragon sat in his cave waiting for the knight to approach.

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☒ The ferocious dragon | ☐ waiting for the knight |
| ☐ in his cave | ☐ to approach |

The expanded noun phrase is the **ferocious dragon** because the simple noun phrase **the dragon** has been expanded using the adjective **ferocious**.

6. Which conjunction could be added to the sentence below so that it makes sense?

Tick one.

_____ it was getting late, Jake couldn't put down his book and go to sleep.

- | | |
|--|----------------------------------|
| ☐ because | ☐ when |
| ☒ although | ☐ whether |

The word **although** is the most appropriate conjunction.

7. Underline the subordinate clause in each of the sentences below.

Jivan and his sister entered the tunnel even though they knew it could be dangerous.

Place the cakes in the oven until they turn a golden-brown.

When he was hungry, Ewan ate a banana.

While the teacher was talking, Imran played with his fidget spinner.

A **subordinate clause** is a clause that can not be used as a sentence on its own.

8. Which of the following is a simple sentence? Tick one.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☒ The sleek, black jaguar had a refreshing drink of cool water. | ☐ The jaguar drank water while the birds twittered above. |
| ☐ After hunting, the jaguar had a drink of water. | ☐ The jaguar walked to the river and had a drink of water. |

Although it contains some expanded noun phrases, the first sentence is a **simple sentence** because it is only made up of a **single clause**.

11+ English Practice Paper

Grammar and Punctuation: Test 4

1. What type of sentence is the following? Tick one.

Early one morning, Natasha went for a jog by the beach.

☐ Simple

☐ Complex

☐ Compound

2. What is the relative clause in the sentence below? Tick one.

The fastest man alive, Usain Bolt, who is a professional runner, has won eight gold medals at the Summer Games.

☐ The fastest man alive

☐ has won eight gold medals

☐ who is a professional runner

☐ at the Olympics

3. Tick the sentences that contain a modal verb.

☐ I like cake because it tastes nice.

☐ You must finish your work before you go out to play.

☐ We might go on holiday to Spain during half term.

☐ The plane to Alicante will take off at 8.30 pm.

4. Which of the following phrases is written in the present progressive? Tick one.

☐ was eating

☐ has eaten

☐ is eating

☐ will eat



5. Write the contracted form of the words in brackets in the paragraph below.

Jamie (was not) _____ feeling very well. He (could not) _____ go to school so (he would) _____ have to stay at home. His mum said, “(I will) _____ ring school to let them know.”

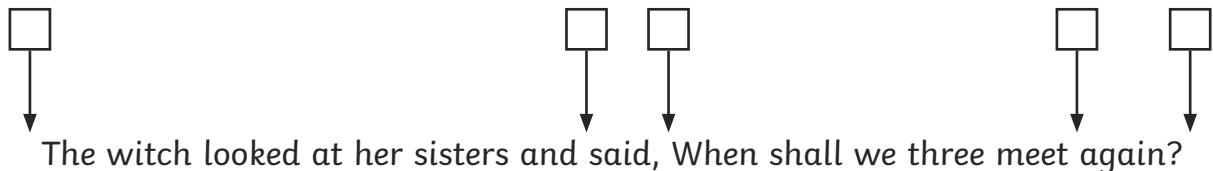
6. Tick the exclamation sentences below.

- ☐ How did it get so cold
 - ☐ What a lovely idea
 - ☐ How cold it is
 - ☐ What was the idea

7. Place a semi-colon in the correct place in the sentence below.

The tiger was feeling hungry it was time to go hunting.

8. Tick the boxes that show where the inverted commas should be placed.



11+ English Practice Paper

Grammar and Punctuation: Test 4

Answers

1. What type of sentence is the following? Tick one.

Early one morning, Natasha went for a jog by the beach.

☒ Simple

☐ Complex

☐ Compound

A **simple sentence** contains only one clause. As **Early one morning** is an adverbial phrase, this sentence is a simple sentence.

2. What is the relative clause in the sentence below? Tick one.

The fastest man alive, Usain Bolt, who is a professional runner, has won eight gold medals at the Summer Games.

☐ The fastest man alive

☐ has won eight gold medals

☒ who is a professional runner

☐ at the Olympics

A **relative clause** begins with **who, which, whose, whom, when, where** or **that**.

3. Tick the sentences that contain a modal verb.

☐ I like cake because it tastes nice.

☒ You must finish your work before you go out to play.

☒ We might go on holiday to Spain during half term.

☒ The plane to Alicante will take off at 8.30 pm.

The **modal verbs** in these sentences are **might, must** and **will**.

4. Which of the following phrases is written in the present progressive? Tick one.

☐ was eating

☐ has eaten

☒ is eating

☐ will eat

The **present progressive** describes an action that is currently happening.

5. Write the contracted form of the words in brackets in the paragraph below.

Jamie (was not) wasn't feeling very well. He (could not) couldn't go to school so (he would) he'd have to say at home. His mum said, "(I will) I'll ring school to let them know."

Contracted forms of words include an apostrophe and one or more missing letters.

6. Tick the exclamation sentences below.

☐ How did it get so cold

☒ What a lovely idea

☒ How cold it is

☐ What was the idea

These sentences are **exclamation sentences** rather than questions as they are showing surprise.

7. Place a semi-colon in the correct place in the sentence below.

The tiger was feeling hungry; it was time to go hunting.

The **semicolon** separates the two clauses.

8. Tick the boxes that show where the inverted commas should be placed.



The witch looked at her sisters and said, When shall we three meet again?

The **speech marks** need to go around the speech.